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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, March 18, 2021

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eMU5k9aPH2M
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:06] don't have to stop talking but just wanted to give a heads up it says ready all right we are now live

[00:00:38] on youtube great always wanted to be a youtube star if only this came with the millions of dollars that youtube stars apparently make damn the influencer influencer yeah i bought that book gotta be an influencer you know yeah influence people to drink water that's a good way to use your influence you think we ought to start doing product placements probably not a bad idea

[00:01:16] mine is always coffee yeah we could start wearing the bristol t-shirts and yeah that we got when we were down on the southwest tour oh yeah so much good stuff on that tour lots of goodies all right i'm gonna just share my screen so that folks that are hopping on the live stream know what meeting

[00:01:54] this is and I'll pull it down uh when we get started Dan that's fine thanks and you all will note um we have a we've done a a bit of a rebranding for both the department um and with the board so I am using our new kind of board brand which doesn't really change we kind of keep the same you know state seal and colors but bring us a little bit more in line with the the new DOE logo

[00:02:24] so shout out to to tim um in our communications and office who did a great job yeah it does look nice i'm thinking if doe has a new logo perhaps the board ought to lobby for one too what do you

think jamelle i think we have a few other things we could spend our time doing no no no being distracted is a good thing we are like the squirrels well when i was working with tim on this actually you know we talked about that but given that you know this is the only board outlined

[00:03:01] in the the constitution we wanted to make sure that we kept the the state seal there i appreciate that i know as you know it'd be the last thing on my list is to redo i know i'm gonna unplug that thing because it may ring during the meeting give me a second morning morning morning all wow lots

[00:03:35] of folks have joined us good morning everybody good morning morning secretary holton anthony please call me and i'll have to call you mr swan either ann or uh president holton that's right that's right i will tell you the other members when i start cross-examining witnesses they call

[00:04:01] me judge ann but other than that just call me ann i had too many formers anthony are you and your teacher of the year year now i can't remember whether or you were named this fall and so next year is your this is my year i'm in that name so does that mean you're still in the classroom or are you uh to travel and stuff i mean i know it's weird but well my district placed me on a temporary

[00:04:38] sabbatical because they felt like it was just too much yeah okay so that's a district level thing so um so you're not getting to travel in real real world but are you getting to do some virtual stuff i'm actually getting to do both oh good oh wow that asked me to come out here to do a workshop in excess um esses county not too long ago great thank you good morning susan good morning how are

[00:05:13] you good are you good it'll be nice when we can meet in person i know we'll be it's coming i think what are we targeting june now that'll be great yes we are that is our target to to be back in person in some form or fashion in june thank you for getting i will say we we won't be back in the

[00:05:47] boardroom because there's no way to social distance on that dais in the boardroom um so we're we're We're exploring some different venues within some of the different buildings around us.

[00:06:03] Maybe even potentially outside if we can make that happen in warmer weather. So, working on the logistics now and hope to have more information to share, obviously with board members and the public soon. - Great, all right.

[00:06:19] - Thanks for working on that and also for getting us in the vaccine queue. Yes, thank you very much for that. - Well, we know it's time to get back in person and we know that vaccines are a way that we can do that.

[00:06:36] So glad to be getting more folks vaccinated. Dan, I'll go ahead and stop screen share so we can see kind of who's on. - Yeah.

[00:06:54] - I feel like we're still waiting on Dr. Duran to join us.

[00:07:19] Oh, and Ms. Davis Vaughn. - We'll give it a few minutes, you know, travel from Bristol's hard.

[00:07:35] Actually, are they the two with the most real jobs? I think they're both in person. Well, I don't know, I assume, I don't know about Francisco. - I don't know, I think Stuart might disagree. He's got a real job. - We are all serving in different means.

[00:07:54] - Yeah. - Yes, I would second that. - I think Anne's point was some have greater flexibility than others. - Yeah, I think that's fair. - Those who are in the school buildings today are,

[00:08:11] heart is out to them as always all right we do have uh miss davis vott good morning everyone i'm

[00:08:49] sorry we're getting ready to have a storm that's okay no problem we totally understand and now we also have dr duran so good board right and we're alive yes we are live perfect well then we'll call the meeting to order thank you everybody for being here uh as i noted yesterday the board is delighted now to have a full complement of nine board members we added two we will go over that after the morning announcements now i feel like a school principal being able to say that the morning

[00:09:24] announcements but first the roll call of members since we're doing this virtually miss davis vaught present dr duran president miss holton president dr mann uh dr pexton present yes i can see you okay now there we go uh dr robertson uh mr swan president and dr wilson president great and i'm

[00:09:58] here so uh first item will be the approval of minutes from the january 27 28 meetings for the board uh have you had a chance to review the minutes and uh are there any edits or revisions needed if not you know is there a motion either way here i make a motion president gecker to approve as written? Yes, sir. Great. Thank you. Pam, is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Duran.

[00:10:24] Again, all things by roll call. Ms. Davis-Vault? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Pexton? Aye. Dr. Robertson? Aye. Mr. Swan? Aye. And Dr. Wilson? Aye. Great. Okay. Sort of the virtual meeting remarks now. Good morning. Welcome to the Board of Education's virtual meeting. Our meeting today is being streamed live on the VDOE YouTube channel and on the Board's public meeting webpage.

[00:11:00] We'd like to welcome those joining us on the live stream from across the Commonwealth. A couple of things to note about our virtual meeting. One, the Board accepted written public comment for this meeting. All comments that were, excuse me, that were received by 5 pm on Tuesday have been uploaded to our meeting webpage and shared with Board members in time for them to review in advance of today's meeting. Comments received after 5 p.m. on Tuesday will be provided to the board in a timely manner. Two, for our YouTube watchers, the chat feature is disabled

[00:11:32] as it is not monitored by staff. The best way to contact the board is by email at doe.virginia.gov. As I mentioned before, we are now at a full complement of nine. The last two appointees to the board are Dr. Stuart Robertson and Mr. Anthony Swan. Their bios are amazingly promptly up on the state board webpage. And so you can read them there. But I would like to give each of them an opportunity just to say hello and give, if you don't mind, just a brief background.

[00:12:10] This is not my way of hazing initiation. It is just, you know, a way to get to meet you. you know i will say that you know even yesterday's meeting you know the strains of meeting online or the differences in meeting online as opposed to in person are pretty significant particularly when we have new people coming on board and so we look forward to welcoming you in public you know in person but for now just a little brief background dr robertson mr president thank you i i am i'm

[00:12:42] sure just like anthony swan uh very honored to to be asked to serve uh not uh real sure how much i should go into detail uh with a 65 year old life uh but i will um i'll hit some highlights just to put it all in perspective as it relates to board service i'm a native of patrick county virginia that's in the foothills of blue ridge mountains on the north carolina border it took me though 50 years to tell people how to pronounce my name uh it's it's robertson without

[00:13:14] the t so i'm doing everyone that favor here i'm one of three children of a mother who is now 93 years old who became a widow when we were five nine and twelve she had very little means she relied on resourcefulness and community networking to provide for us all so a lot of of early support came from family and teachers and community leaders. It was in the fourth grade when I was elected reporter of my 4-H club that I tasted leadership first. I'm a graduate of Patrick County High School and was active in student government. Very fortunate to obtain my

[00:13:53] degrees from the University of Virginia, which prepared me then, and I think still does, for a very fulfilling life's journey. I started my K-12 education career as a middle school teacher, algebra and science, social studies, and debate. Became a middle school and high school assistant principal and principal. Served for 21 years as a superintendent, first in Falls Church and retired from Hanover County. It was in Hanover where I met Dr. Wilson and our long-standing friendship and colleague relationship was formed. She followed me as superintendent and cleaned

[00:14:28] up my mess as well. Dan Gecker and I presided over the renovation of Maggie Walker High School to become the governor's school during those years. I promoted an aggressive capital agenda in Falls Church and in Hanover. And in Hanover, we focused a great deal on creating educational opportunity for all students in a fast-growing, changing community. We promoted international baccalaureate, CTE, JROTC, extracurricular activities, and more. Along the way, I've been

[00:15:00] fortunate to be a leader in the VEA, VSSP, VAS, VASCD, Advanced Ed, and IB. I retired as a K-12 educator after 35 years. In 2011, I joined Mosley Architects as their president, where I've continued to be involved in capital planning on a very large scale as we serve public and private clients across the nation and on four continents. I serve as a professor of practice in the UVA School of Education and Human Development. I teach in the administration supervision program.

[00:15:37] I chair the UVA K-12 advisory committee at UVA and Francisco Duran and Jamel and James and Leah and Rusty have all attended those meetings. Our signature program is designed to feed leadership succession pipelines across the state with principals and with assistant principals and school board office leaders holly and james have promoted annual policy summits with the council for the last four years my interests today include realizing equity leadership succession autism services and in the virginia rural horseshoe initiative the rural horseshoe initiative was

[00:16:15] conceived by the late governor gerald blouse and pushes college and career coaches into high schools and community colleges it's an initiative that's supported by the virginia Community College System Foundation Board and the Patrick County Education Foundation organizations that I currently chair. At the state level, I've been honored to be asked to serve previously in a number of capacities, including the Joint Commission on School Accountability, the Virginia Report Card Committee, the School Safety Commission, and the SOL Innovation Committee, where I work very closely with Ann and James and

[00:16:49] Holly and Jamel. Believe it or not, I have time to enjoy being with my family, Leslie, who is professor emeritus from Randolph-Macon College. Our daughter Meredith is a supervisor of mental health clinicians. Our son Jeff is a surgery resident.

[00:17:05] And we have a four-year-old grandson, Nate, and a one-year-old granddaughter, Claire. And we all enjoy travel a great deal. Again, it's an honor to be asked to serve. I look forward to learning even further from each of our colleagues on the board and the strong DOE team.

[00:17:20] Thank you, Mr. President. I hope that wasn't too long. Thank you. Perfect. Thank you very much. Mr. Swan. Anthony Swann: Thank you, Mr President. My name is Anthony Swann. I currently teach fifth grade at Rocky Mill Elementary in Franklin County, Virginia. I have the honor to be the 2021 Virginia Teacher of the Year.

[00:17:43] Anthony Swann: I was also just recently appointed as a mentor for the Teacher Promise Institute as well. It is an honor to be able to serve on this board. I bring you 14 years of educational experience.

[00:17:59] I graduated from George Washington High School in Danville, Virginia, and I received my undergraduate from Averick University, also in Danville, Virginia, and my graduate degree from Regent University. I'm just looking forward to serving on this platform.

[00:18:17] I love serving children. I love being in the educational realm. In 2018, I was able to start a program at my school called Guys With Ties, and that program has helped with our school disciplinary rates.

[00:18:33] Before I started the program, we were at 69% disciplinary rates for our African-American males, and after I started the program, it dropped to 22%. As well as school-wide, we were at 22% disciplinary rates, and that dropped to 9%.

[00:18:52] percent so I'm just looking forward to bringing a teacher's perspective to the board and looking forward to serve it's great to be here thank you welcome to both of you I will say you know I practiced I ran a law firm for 17 years and the one rule of hiring that we had was we wanted to hire people smarter than we were I am very thankful that the governor has seen fit to continue to surround me with people who are smarter than I am so welcome to both and we look forward to your years of service with us okay uh consent agenda well let me let me make one agenda note first

[00:19:31] which is item i i don't know if you all have read the comments that we've received or had any discussions about item i um it is my belief that we ought to defer that item and i'm going to exercise i guess my prerogative as chair to defer item i until the april meeting i'm a i guess that can be overridden if there's an objection is there any objection to that okay good consent agenda agenda items a through f uh is there a motion either to adopt the consent

[00:20:04] agenda uh as it you know as is or to remove an item for discussion make a motion to this okay thank you dr duran and the second sorry second uh thank you dr man uh again all votes by roll call uh miss davis vaught uh dr duran hi miss holton hi dr mann hi dr pexton hi dr robertson

[00:20:35] hi mr swan hi and dr wilson hi and i vote i also it takes us to uh item g the first of the discussion items final review of revised foundation blocks for learning uh there she is we are delighted to have back with us jenna conway chief school readiness officer for the commonwealth and look forward as always to your presentation excellent good morning all this is a fairly brief agenda item but wanted to come back in front of the board

[00:21:13] in particular to thank dr man for working very closely with us we have made a set of specific revisions really focused on the introduction to the early learning and development standards to make sure that they accurately reflect what the standards are and what they're not you know that they are not to be used for example as an assessment for children we have also tried to be very thoughtful about how we

have treated educators and the language throughout the introduction so that as we look to roll this out to the increasingly broad set of

[00:21:53] stakeholders that are part of the early childhood sector or team under the board and working partnership with the Department of Education that it feels inclusive of all educators. So, that's the gist of the changes. Again, huge appreciation to Dr. Mann for really thoroughly going through and helping us sort of think through how this could be received. We also have made sure and sort of double checked all of the references which seem in a a good place to go forward and provided everything is good with the board we'll proceed uh from here one um and we're

[00:22:33] working with our partners around training materials and supports one update since i spoke to you last we're very excited we are in the final stages of of securing a partnership with a public institution to develop a micro-credential um you know based on the standards so really trying to figure out for the diverse family day home child care school-based and head start educators how we make this content which as you all know and having reviewed it prior to the meeting it's a little bit inaccessible right now it's many many pages which we need right because we cover birth to five

[00:23:08] and all of the spectrum of children's learning and development but really thinking about how we can do on folks mobile devices right so on their phone or tablet help make this content accessible to them over the next year and this largely came from some of the work that we've done to pilot this in northern virginia with family day home educators who are appreciative of the content but potentially we just need to be really thoughtful about how we practically make this content accessible to them so that's i think the update from when we spoke last and again huge thanks to dr mann for her help on this okay and the request is to approve it

[00:23:43] at this meeting is that right thank you yes please thank you very much are there any comments mr president yes dr man yes i just want to um in in turn express my incredible appreciation to miss conaway and her team um i think the opportunity we had to really engage around um the content um was really very important and i am very enthusiastic regarding the work uh that is to come as the board of education really takes on ownership for a continuum of education and

[00:24:22] development that has had a history long before education is stepping into the space and we just want to make sure that as we do that we are definitely aware of the importance of not losing the incredible diversity that exists across this sector that is so, so very important for children's development in these most early years. So I really want to again thank Ms. Conway and her entire team for the work we had an opportunity to do in looking at this a bit more

[00:25:00] closely. Thank you. Anybody else have any comments or questions? If not, is there a motion to adopt item g in the floor yes i just want to also follow up on dr mann so eloquently said but i want to share my appreciation uh jenna for you and your staff and everyone putting together a unified set of standards for virginia is so powerful and important to help us move our commonwealth forward the foundation of learning at these early years is so critical to the success of children

[00:25:36] moving forward and having consistency around the commonwealth so that we can as a commonwealth state that no matter where you live what part of the commonwealth you live in no matter what provider you attend you have this we are expecting the same set of standards and we're going to support you to get there and we talked last time about the professional development and asked you some questions about that i know you're working on that because i do think that's the next very important piece

to this is how are we making sure this is being implemented and not just saying that now we have standards which is great but what are we doing to really affect change and that in my mind is empowering our educators through the professional learning they need so i know you're

[00:26:16] committed to that general but i want to just reiterate that i think that that's an important next step for us and thank you for taking us to this next stage and i hope that we'll continue to be a national leader in this there are many many states that can look to us as an example of having a commonwealth-wide set of expectations standards and support for everyone to move our children forward and the last thing is the tension that was given um to really the differentiated needs of our english learners our students with disabilities our students who have not generally had access or who when they have had access has not been equitable so i appreciate that also

[00:26:54] attention that was done here so i just want to thank you very very much for the work that you have done and the work you will do to continue to make this become a reality across the commonwealth okay anybody else thank you dr duran no all right uh geez do we have the motion in the second i think we so moved thank you dr man is there a second second uh thank you dr wilson again roll call

[00:27:25] Ms. Davis-Faught? Aye. Dr. Duran? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Dr. Paxton? Aye. Dr. Robertson? Aye. Mr. Swan? Aye. And Dr. Wilson? Aye. And I vote aye. Thank you all. And thank you, Jenna, very much. This is an exciting phase for us to enter into a whole new sort of subject area, you know, for the board to address as we move forward.

[00:27:59] Okay, item H, final review of proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers, Ms. Pitts and Dr. Strong. Good morning, President Gecker, members of the board, and Dr. Lane.

[00:28:19] Also on a personal note, I want to welcome Dr. Robertson and Mr. Swan to the board. I've had the pleasure of working with both of them in the past and look forward to the future. I am pleased to present today the final review of proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers.

[00:28:40] I begin by thanking the work group composed of representatives from professional organizations, including teachers, a counselor, a school library media specialist, principals, superintendent, assistant superintendents, and central office instructional representatives.

[00:29:00] During the process, Dr. James Strong and Dr. Jenny Tonnelson of Strong and Associates worked with us on this initiative, and I certainly do want to thank them for their work. To briefly recap, in January, the Board received proposed recommendations for revisions to the guidelines.

[00:29:19] guidelines. You have before you the proposed guidelines and revisions to the document presented to the Board on January 28, 2021 are highlighted in yellow and revisions since the first review are highlighted in blue. Since the January presentation to the Board, the Department of Education, including the Office of Equity and Community Engagement, led by Leah Walker, made revisions in standard six, culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices and its indicators, including language to articulate

[00:29:59] that this standard is inclusive of gender, race, ethnicity, English language learners, and students with disabilities. And as you know, this is a three phase initiative. Phase one was completed and became effective in January of 2020.

[00:30:18] Those revisions solely address the weighting of the performance standards for the evaluation of teachers. We are now in phase two of this initiative and I will address phase two momentarily. Phase three will begin in April next month and it will involve a comprehensive revision of the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers, including the development of a model evaluation system.

[00:30:49] In response to the board's request in January, a forward was added to the document to highlight the following. Phase two is intended as a bridge between the current and future teacher performance evaluation systems. And the major revision to the guidelines in phase two is the creation of the new performance standard, culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices.

[00:31:15] The establishment of this performance standard also addresses House Bill 1904, which was passed by the 2021 General Assembly, requiring that evaluations must include an evaluation of cultural competency.

[00:31:33] Also in the Ford, it does encourage school divisions to use multiple data sources in the evaluation system, including teacher artifacts, student surveys, self-evaluations, student achievement, goal setting.

[00:31:52] The forward also reiterates the importance of professional development through feedback and coaching. At this time, I'd like to turn the presentation over to Dr. Strong and he is going to highlight the revisions since the January presentation.

[00:32:10] Dr. Strong. - Thank you, Ms. Pitts. Good morning, board members, Mr. Superintendent, ladies and gentlemen. And Emily, if you would just proceed the next slide for us this is a pretty simple and short presentation but let me just walk us through this and then turn it turn it back to you uh patty or to you mr gecker as is appropriate for standard six we have presented the original language and revised language in terms of the

[00:32:46] standard the standard is highlighted but the revision is highlighted in gray as you as you you have before you. The original is also presented. Underneath the language of the standard is included each of the performance indicators. You can think of performance indicators as look-fors. This would be the evidence that a supervisor would observe, document through artifacts or through other measures for the actual performance of the new standard on culturally responsive teaching and equitable practices. Additionally, the indicators provide for the

[00:33:26] teacher the guidance on what good practice should reflect, what it should encompass. So it becomes a definition for this standard of what is good teaching, what is effective teaching, just as it does for each of the other standards. The new standard moves us from seven to eight standards in the uniform standards and guidelines, and if adopted by the board, will be followed through with an evaluation model handbook that can be used by school divisions across the Commonwealth.

[00:34:05] The older version has been used extensively, and we anticipate the same will occur here. So a very quick walkthrough. 6.1, you can see the language. Unless you request it, I see no point in repeating what's here. 6.2, and Emily, could we proceed? The numbering is slightly different

[00:34:42] because of some new, a new indicator that was included. So 6.3 is now revised as 6.4 related to curriculum and instructional resources. The next is the original 6.4 relates to using text, materials and

classroom resources that are culturally inclusive. 6.5 with some of the reordering is now 6.1 disaggregating data of a variety of sources by student groups and identifying

[00:35:21] and meeting needs based on differentiated assessment and instructional and planning strategies. Next slide please Emily. 6.6 remains as such and it relates to communication strategies that are inclusive within the classroom across many of the areas that Dr. Duran especially pointed out at the February meeting and point six also remains as such with new language that's

[00:35:58] included related to skills for communication and engagement for diversity in a variety of ways including across the many areas of diversity that we see in our classrooms everywhere in the Commonwealth of Virginia and across America. The next slide. So that is a summary of the primary changes that occurred to the document with standard six. There are some changes to the performance appraisal rubric. It's a four-point rubric. The original language is on the top. The

[00:36:35] revised language you will see on the bottom. This is technical language that's used by evaluators in their training to build inter-rater reliability and in their actual practices to determine the summative evaluation ratings for each of the seven or now eight performance standards that go into the evaluation for for teachers emily and then the final slide is simply a summation of continuing

[00:37:12] and completing phase two which includes a next step of upon approval of the uniform standards creating a new teacher performance evaluation system handbook that will include language for specialty teaching areas like english science in fact 10 different areas that we will form a work group to proceed with that. That's listed for April and we will have subject matter expert

[00:37:47] work groups developing those content specific indicators as needed along with some related materials such as artifacts. Once those documents are completed we'll move to creating the training materials with the intention of delivering training in sessions during the summer that are repeat session so it will be convenient for participants from evaluators and teachers who are invited from across the Commonwealth.

[00:38:16] And then this will finish with additional rollout with training and development. So that, Mr. Board President, is the completion of the presentation. So Ms. Pitts, do I turn this back to you or to you, Mr. Decker?

[00:38:34] I would always yield to Ms. Pitts. I just want to um provide the superintendent's recommendation on this item and the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education approve the proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for teachers and allow the department of education to make technical edits to the document if needed thank you very much thank you uh both to both of you thank you very much are there any comments or

[00:39:08] questions by board members at this time uh dr garan and then miss halton um yes i just want to thank um everyone for working with me we also met i had a meeting offline between um board meetings to really in my mind what i see you've accomplished here is to really clarify and articulate more a couple of things one in the rubric that the focus on cultural responsiveness and teaching and equitable practices really should result in academic achievement for students and i think that

[00:39:44] it's an area that we often can get lost when we think about just creating a positive environment where people feel welcome but then at the end of the day there's no change for students success and so

what what's you've done here very well in the revision on the appraisal rubric is really called out things like supporting academic achievement for all students advancing academic growth inclusion of that language there I think solidifies and strengthens what we're expecting with regards to really truly meeting cultural responsive teaching and equitable outcomes for students so thank you for that and also this from my colleagues awareness you know

[00:40:25] on the indicator 6.5 I had requested that we move to 6.1 and I see that happened and that was because 6.5 as it previously was is really around disaggregating the assessment data and really understanding where the growth and the needs are for students and i think that's where you should begin if you're going to begin to work with students from a cultural responsive lens is knowing where they are knowing who they are knowing what their needs are what are those gaps so that you can then do what the other indicators speak to around building that classroom environment, creating meaningful relationships with students, analyzing the

[00:41:02] appropriate resources that you would use, and the text and the materials that would reflect who those students are. But if we don't start out in this with really knowing who our students are through data, whether it's in behavioral data, whether it's attendance data, whether it's disaggregated assessment data, if we don't start with that, then we often can miss where we're trying to go when we go on to the next phases of really building that environment of inclusivity so i really really appreciate um where i think this strengthening of this document has gone

[00:41:38] and i think it's going to be able to be used in the intended an intention that i think we all wanted it to be uh we at the as the board have talked about equity about changing outcomes for students and this is yet another tool that i hope will help um school divisions principals and teachers get to where we need to be so that ultimately again as i said in the approval of the appraisal rubric academic achievement and changes for students we cannot get into a space where we think that being culturally responsive is just making people feel welcome is just making

[00:42:12] people feel that they're included we have to make sure that that results in success and changes in performance for students and that i think the changes that you've outlined here will will help us to get there. So thank you, Leah Walker, Patty Pitts, Dr. Lane, who met with me and we talked through this in detail.

[00:42:32] And I really, really applaud the changes that have been made in those revisions. So I fully look forward to supporting this very much. Thank you. - Yeah, I think Ms. Holton and then Mr. Swan. - Thank you.

[00:42:47] I'll echo Dr. Duran on thanking all those, including the task force that have put so much good work into this and look forward in particular to the training and implementation around the equity and inclusion cultural responsible, responsive standards.

[00:43:04] I think it's a very exciting development and so glad we are able to meet the legal requirements of the bill that was just recently signed that we're ahead of the game, so to speak, on helping implement that. I'm also grateful for the new language that was added to the forward putting this in the context because I do think that we are about to embark on a broader look at not just the standards, but how they fit into an evaluation system for our teachers.

[00:43:33] And I'm really looking forward to that. I have concerns and questions about the two sections of the forward, the multiple data sources section and the professional development section. The sentiments expressed there, think probably makes sense and some of them are reflected already in the rest of the document but this new language that was added in the forward i'm not sure what where that's coming from or what it's seeking to achieve and i am concerned basically it looks to me like this is some good

[00:44:10] research that we should have presented to us at a subsequent meeting as part of the beginning of phase three but i don't understand why it's here in the forward and uh if it if there's a reason and it needs to stay so i would suggest that we just drop those two sections from here i don't unless there's um and that the rest of the document already adequately addresses those topics if not maybe there's some way it can be added into the research section of the document but if as here it i worry that it's more the board it seems to suggest that the board's made

[00:44:48] findings that we haven't yet done for instance the language i mean just one example there's language on student surveys and i'm really excited about the possibility of building up our capacity and our um and the the weight that we place on student surveys so i don't mean to disparage the content but there's a language here under student surveys that says studies have found that students ratings are the best predictor of student achievement better than the ratings from principals and teachers i don't actually know that that's true and i went to look at the footnote footnote

[00:45:22] one it doesn't exist several of the footnotes for this section don't exist so i wasn't able to check the sources and um you know some of that might just be technical edits that can be fixed but my point is more is this really something we want to put in a forward as language that we've all you know are that we're all ready to endorse or is this more a question that we want to explore together starting in april student surveys may be the very best predictor i thought i've heard that

[00:45:56] that teacher observations are the strongest piece of of teacher evaluations but i don't know whether they're the best predictor of student achievement maybe test scores are the best predictor or maybe student surveys are but you get my point i just this is something i want to learn more about but i'm wary of reaching conclusions on a number of pieces like that in this added language in the forward so again maybe there's a reason it got added i'd love to hear that and if so then maybe we can figure out how to clean it up well let me just to clarify because i missed part of the beginning of what you said and uh you would remove the uh multiple data sources as well as the

[00:46:36] professional development through feedback and coaching is that right yes i would suggest remove them unless there's some reason they've been i mean i'm open to hearing what why they've been added and is there some some role they're filling that i'm not aware of and if so then i think they need some cleanup i'll i'll address that mr gecker if you'd like sure uh we're completely comfortable with striking those sections we thought we were doing that at your request that was our reasoning Not you personally, but at the board's request.

[00:47:06] I think it would be fair to say that the forward as drafted here reflects, you know, a response to a number of comments made at the last meeting. You know, I would not go so far as to say it was a board request at that time, but certainly it was a clear effort and a good effort to respond to very specific issues raised when this item first came up.

[00:47:34] I mean, is that fair, James? yeah I agree with that okay if there are others so I don't mean to squelch if there are others who see a role for this it may be that there's a better place to put it isn't there a

research section of the document that sort of summarizes relevant research yeah since I may have you know some of the stronger opinions on this topic I would agree with you with regards in particular to multiple data sources not that I think it's wrong but that I think we haven't reached that conclusion yet as a board and it's not necessary to move this forward uh with regard to professional

[00:48:11] development through feedback and coaching you know i don't want to draft on a zoom meeting but you know it is clear to me that one of our goals is to have the phase three system be one in which we better develop professional development through the feedback from the evaluation system and make that very affirmative link between the evaluations and as required by code the professional development recommended for each teacher and i think and again in fairness to staff that this is an effort to and patty you can correct me if i'm wrong about this as i assume you

[00:48:49] had a large hand in this an effort to basically say that uh we acknowledge as a department and therefore we acknowledge as a board the importance of development through feedback and coaching and this is some of the work that sits underneath it whether it's necessary to put in this document at this length I think is a fair subject for discussion uh but and then again I think though the concept of what we expect phase three to accomplish is a much more uh integrated system

[00:49:23] where teachers are supported by the professional development recommendations that come out of the evaluation system i mean as you know and you know some of the and anthony i'm sorry that i have actually jumped in line on this but you know i guess it's one of the few prerogatives as chair uh you know we talked somewhere in this document about uh you know correctly stating that in a place like washington dc you know they used basically the evaluations to eliminate lower performing teachers and thus raised in their outputs essentially um i think that is a fair

[00:50:02] you know commentary on what the current evaluation system does and again i think you would contrast that with where i expect us to head which is not a system that is designed to you know weed out if you will for performing teachers about what ought to do that as a byproduct but a system that is built to as i said dovetail development with weaknesses and thus improving the quality of outcome throughout uh the education system in the commonwealth and that's sort of you know where we're going and i know james will say it's a three-year project it may well be that

[00:50:37] uh but as i said that is the next direction of the board uh in conjunction with you know the comprehensive work plan and everything we've talked about now anthony i'm sorry to have uh jumped in line there it doesn't happen often uh but i know you had some comments and then dr wilson i actually let dr wilson go before i go all right dr wilson chivalry on display um so actually my comment does tie to this conversation that we're just having i think

[00:51:13] um i raised in our last meeting a desire to see what i anticipated or envisioned was a teaser to what phase three would look like to encompass or to connect the dots among all of the different conversations that we're having as well as to professional development and you know these ideas around multiple data sources so the information that's here in the forward i suspect may have been a response to that request that i made and i'm it was clearly inarticulate

[00:51:47] in um expecting or asking that it just be a teaser so this idea that we have here in the three phases phase three um that may be a little in my view even now maybe a little more fleshed out but i agree with ann that the material that we have here under multiple data sources and professional development goes further than i had anticipated or envisioned that it would go

[00:52:15] Thank you, Mr. Swan. May I, Mr. Swan, jump into a language suggestion? Perhaps deleting those two sections but adding a sentence at the end of the phase three that says the new system is expected to address the importance or to build on the importance of using multiple data sources in in evaluation and on integrating professional development through feedback and coaching.

[00:52:52] - Maybe I haven't- - Something like that would satisfy. I think that would serve us well. - But add a sentence there that basically takes the headlines of those two sections. - Certainly, we'll be glad to do that.

[00:53:12] - And before we- - I'm sorry, Dr. Strong. - I apologize, just to round this out, I wanted to say if in the meantime, board members And in particular, Ms. Holton, if you're interested in the research, all of those research items that are noted in the foreword are included in the end notes to the first four end notes, and they're highlighted in blue.

[00:53:36] So if you wanted to go to the research there to get a head start on it, they're there for you. Thank you. All right. Nobody else is going to speak now except to Mr. Swan. So I'm looking at this from the perspective of teachers.

[00:53:53] So this standard has changed. i know that i've heard the language of feedback and support and professional development but how in those trainings with the evaluators how will they be trained to support those veteran teachers who are just stuck in their ways like who who don't accept the culturally uh responsive module

[00:54:21] how will the support be there for those teachers who who just won't budge that's my concern president gecker oh i thought we were going to get a response first yeah no i well you want the staff to respond but it's interesting hey all right dr man i appreciate uh mr swan's point and what's interesting to me about it is i was thinking i i absolutely love the language that we have articulated in this new standard and i i think it's absolutely a direction we should be moving

[00:55:00] in and i was actually thinking wow how incredible it would be to actually understand how that transformation happens through a professional development experience where conditions of the heart if i may block people's ability to uptake the opportunity to live out what these words articulate and to the extent that as the professional development experiences are being planned and there are opportunities to encourage districts to really capture and appreciate

[00:55:39] what's making the difference as you are evaluating educators against this standard, I think it's going to be incredibly important because the words that these new standards articulate go well beyond an intellectual experience, and how we understand movement in that is going to be fundamentally important to success here.

[00:56:10] So that's my sense of what I was triggered as I thought about the question that was proposed, but also what was operating in my mind as I think about the importance of what this language represents.

[00:56:26] - All right, yeah, Mr. Swan. So my follow-up, the reason why I said that is because in my district we have started our culturally responsive module for teachers, but there are some teachers within our district that we have provided professional development.

[00:56:47] They are just not budging because they just feel like, why do I have to change who I am? They don't want to go with the times because they've been teaching for 25, 30 years. So if we start evaluating

them, I just want to make sure that the supports are in place for those veteran teachers so it won't actually push them out the door if they're not ready to leave.

[00:57:12] Dr. Lane, I know you and I have had this discussion. Yeah, thank you for the question, Mr. Swan. And, you know, one of the things I think that Mr. Gecker and I talk about all the time is when you set policy from the state, it will take time for the organizations to bend to the policy. And even as you adopt this today, assuming that you adopt it today, you know, many school boards will have to take many months and

[00:57:48] put these practices in place in their home policies. And so it will drive school divisions to create experiences and trainings around this and put work groups together in their community so they can have community discussion on what it means to become consistent with these standards in each locality and that's when I when I say that the next phase is going to take three years the board will not take three years I think that your work will be done in 18 months or thereabouts but I think it'll be 18 more months that school divisions will bend to this to this new policy and we will certainly provide training for superintendents we will certainly provide

[00:58:26] training for principals as part of phase two you will also have superintendent principal evaluations that will add this sixth standard likely obviously we haven't had that work group yet but that's the intent uh and and so uh in addition to that we have identified equity leads and uh just about every school division we're providing ongoing training we almost do a webinar every week if not every other week on this. The General Assembly appropriated $200,000 to the department to do this kind of training. We're going to have a position at the department appropriated by the General

[00:59:02] Assembly to lead this work throughout the Commonwealth. And so I think that you're going to see a lot of support from the department to localities on how to do this work. And I think you're also going to see that localities will need the time to adopt this in local policy and have it develop i i can go into way more details but that's kind of the high level logistical piece but uh but what i actually think that will look like in the classroom uh you know i think that uh richard said it well yesterday we have to inspect what we expect and that's what this is about and i i think

[00:59:37] that uh on day one there may be teachers who have all gotten uh you know the top rating on every one of the seven categories forever that may see that they have some areas to improve on here and this isn't about firing anybody or pushing anybody out ultimately it's about helping them grow so that they can be at the standard and and and hopefully we can identify leaders that will be above the standard that can help share with their colleagues but but ultimately uh if this is an expectation that we all believe in i know i believe in it uh you know of like other expectations that we've put

[01:00:12] on our staff, everyone that walks in our buildings should really believe in every child in their classroom. And that's at the heart of what we want here. And that should lead to achievement, like Dr. Duran talked about. And so regardless of how difficult this work will be, because it will be difficult, it's too important not to put it in action. President Gekker? Yes, sorry, I muted myself for a minute. Go ahead. I just want to respond to a little bit of that. I also think

[01:00:49] that as Dr. Mann as you stated you know changing the heart and the mind is one of the most difficult things to do and just having this as an expectation uh Mr. Swan without the professional development it it won't happen but I also think that for some in this work we can change that by looking at the data which is why I believe moving 6.5 to 6.1 where we're going to require that we look at the data of

the students that people are serving whether it's behavioral attendance or achievement data and individuals have to identify who are those students that aren't performing well aren't

[01:01:25] being successful or aren't having a good experience and then supporting them with strategies and ways to get there to help them be successful and so whether you have the heart and the man and the motivation to say we need to do good by all we hope that we see that in everyone but for those that haven't quite gotten there on that journey then we have the data to show that here are students in these various subgroups that you're serving that aren't being successful so as a teacher i do believe that that is our charge right all of us need to make sure all of our students are successful so starting out with us indicator 6.1 and really being intentional about here is

[01:02:02] where we need to go because the data is right there in black and white in front of us for this group or that group that aren't being successful that have a gap in a certain area whether it's again attendance behavior or whether it's academic success so how do we start there and then mr swan to your point and dr man to your point how do we then continue to enhance professional learning overall but i think if we can find a way to reiterate that you have to start with that data and the data is glaring we've talked about that at the board table here i know that many school divisions have talked about the data over and over again and so it's very clear

[01:02:39] but are we using it in a way that's intentional to effectuate change? And I think this can help us to do that. But as Dr. Lane said, it's going to take some time for us to see that systemically happen across all classrooms. But I think it's a good start with 6.1 as we indicated.

[01:02:57] David Spott. President Gecker and Dr. Lane, everyone, I am very proud of where the department is going and what we're doing here and to address Dr. Mann, the changing your heart and your mind and Dr. Duran and and to give some validation to Mr. Swan as a principal when we have said the department has set this up so that we will be successful when it comes to the divisions and then down to the divisions to the principals to to make it happen in the classrooms and it basically comes down to

[01:03:33] to looking at your data knowing your children building those relationships that are so very important and from those relationships understanding that you've got to take the teacher down to where the child is to where the child is and and grow up with that child and and to produce with that child so this this can happen and this is the this is a very important piece of what we're doing and moving forward this is something that we can do as building administrators this is something we can do as teachers and and a lot of people are doing it we just haven't put that label of

[01:04:07] culturally responsive teaching on that we've been doing that um and i'm going to throw out also in high poverty school divisions and high poverty schools with we've had to to go down and recognize within us where our shortcomings are and where our heart and where our mind is going to be able to address the individual needs of our children so i'm very proud and i have a lot of faith in everything that's we are moving forward and dr strong thank you very much i think this is excellent i think we're going to i think we're going to make a lot of people proud and we're going to soothe a

[01:04:43] lot of hearts and move forward into our our equity and our culturally responsive building here the teacher evaluation is one piece and i'm on a roll president gecker but also the connectivity to the administrative evaluation and the superintendent evaluation will will help take care of those ends too so it's meeting the children developing those relationships and actually seeing them and recognizing where

they are and the diversity within the classroom as well as the diversity within the building so very proud to be a part of this and thank you very much thank you dr wilson

[01:05:19] dr wilson thank you yes i just had to unmute myself um so um adding thanks um and particularly I know likely, and I think Francisco called her out, but I'll call out Leah and the Office of Equity and Community Engagement because I read a lot of what we have heard coming out of that office over time. So thank you all very much for that. I have a couple of though questions in other areas of the document. In our last meeting, I think it was Ms. Halton who made

[01:05:58] the suggestion that we add the term interim so signaling to the field that this is that this is one step uh before the next fuller step which is phase three and i'm not certain if there was any and i suspect that what we've done here in the laying out the three-phase revision process that that was the intention i am concerned about our being very clear that this is not done that there is more to come yes a longer process but um as we're going to be doing professional development

[01:06:34] around standard six particularly you know this is only one step and i would hate for people to to not have that clear sense and so i'll just leave that there i don't need a response to that but i just acknowledge it the other thing that i note in standard two we have an indicator there that talks about planning for delivery of synchronous and asynchronous lessons and i I don't know if we are intending to say we expect our teacher and as an indicator we would expect our teachers to be able to plan in both modalities and if we are signaling something now.

[01:07:13] about instruction over future time that we really want to be signaling I don't know the answer that question, but I know that we use the word and not and or, and so if it's intentional, maybe just to hear a little bit about that would be helpful. Yeah, and if you've got more, if you don't mind, I'd love to address them kind of one by one, but the interim, we had that discussion.

[01:07:36] I don't know where that got dropped, so from the department standpoint, that is not a barrier to us, if we wanted to add that. But on the standard two, that came from the work group. I think it's a reality of what the work group members, being that they are actually living in that environment, You know suggested they wanted to make sure that there was there was an opportunity to honor the work that's going on there and help people grow in those spaces.

[01:08:03] And, and so you know that could be and or that could be or I you know I don't think that that's a major opposition for us either. I only bring it up because I notice it and if I if i'm seeing it for the first time, and this is new as a teacher as a building leader, what does that mean for me and so just.

[01:08:23] acknowledging that uh it caused me a little bit of question thank you i didn't mean to cut you off there are there others okay great thank you sorry nothing major i have a couple of technical kind of you know grammar stuff but i'll pass that on great thank you all right i'm not quite sure exactly where we are now except let me ask one question uh we do have on you know the board has adopted not this board but in years past the virginia standards for the professional practice

[01:09:00] of teachers that's a document that sits on you know the doe website now i realize i probably think about this backwards but it always seemed to me that you evaluate with you know against standards and is there a plan to revise those standards uh in light of the addition of cultural competency here patty do you want to take that one sure i'll begin and then dr strong please add to my comments That document was created after the performance standards and evaluation criteria were created in

[01:09:36] Virginia. It was created as a companion document or resource for school divisions and the implementation of the performance standards. We do have in our plan to include in our handbook a section specific to major discipline areas that will be part two if you look at the document which you referenced it repeats the performance standards approved by the board of education

[01:10:10] it just it expands on the knowledge and skills for all teachers but then it directly enhances those specialized areas and but they are in the same format as the actual performance standards themselves so our thought is that since this document has not been widely used we very seldom get requests for that document and many people i don't even i'm not sure they

[01:10:43] know it exists we thought that what we would do in the handbook is add an addendum that will specifically address those major discipline areas and the specialized areas on in the handbook where which is widely used and that was a response that we got from school divisions when they were surveyed so dr strong do you have any other comments to add to my explanation i think that's an excellent summary to one just one point is that in April we do have planned or have a plan

[01:11:22] to organize work groups that would address 10 specific specialty areas including counselors but English language arts math science etc and look at these specialty specialty areas embed them directly into the handbook. So there's one document, not two, that teachers and principals would use. And I think Holly created a great metaphor, Mr. Gecker, that I think I shared with you, that by adopting the evaluation system that you're adopting today in its interim phase,

[01:11:58] you're adopting the standards. That document you're referencing was used almost like a curriculum framework as a supplement to the standards, not as the actual adoption of the standards. That's done through this evaluation process.

[01:12:14] - Dr. Wilson, then go ahead. - Go ahead, Mr. Geppi, if you wanna. - No, please go ahead. - Okay, so hearing that these are the standards as we adopt them here, if we look on, so page eight talks about what can school divisions modify.

[01:12:32] This was part of the conversation we had, I think last month. So the first bullet says performance standards should not be modified. So that seems to me to open the door that if a division wanted to, they could modify them. So I'm not certain if we are saying that we are setting standards, that we want language that gives permission for divisions to be able to change this.

[01:12:56] And I'm just asking the question, if folks are reading it the way I am. - The performance standards themselves cannot be modified. The code is clear that evaluation systems must be made based upon the performance standards that are prescribed by the Board of Education.

[01:13:17] So then I might suggest, Patty, that there instead of saying should not be modified, may not be modified. I agree with that. Thank you. All right, you know, I appreciate the explanation of the source of the standards for the professional practice, although honestly you can't, and I certainly understood that the standards in the evaluation guide were the same as those in the professional practice i actually assume that typically you evaluate

[01:13:52] against standards that the standards document came first and the evaluation document followed and i appreciate patty that you're saying that didn't happen although it looks like we had an awful lot of people on a committee in 2004 to generate those standards and if they just came from the evaluation

it seems like a lot of people spent a lot of time just sort of repeating what we'd already done, you know, it is out there as a board approved, you know, guidance document.

[01:14:24] And I'm wondering whether the department really can just sort of, you know, eliminate it or whether the better practice is in fact to have standards against, you know, which we evaluate and have the evaluation methodology actually in the separate document. Now, I appreciate what you've done here. It seems a little bit backwards to me still. I'm not proposing we do it any differently now but I do think that revising the professional standards of practice or having the board vote to eliminate them as a guidance document would be the next step. I mean my preference

[01:14:57] honestly would be to revise them to be consistent with what we are going to in fact evaluate teachers against so that if somebody happened upon this they would know but you know we can leave that I guess to a later day but I would like some thought to be given you know to how we harmonize all the different pieces of stuff we have out there you know it's i know the folks in the department and frankly a lot of you who grew up in the education community you know seem to be able to harmonize these things much better than i can you know coming in and looking at them as discrete

[01:15:34] pieces and trying to understand the integrated whole uh but i i don't think i'm far off based in saying that you know having us present documents that are you know internally consistent or consistent with one another in their framework is a bad thing for us uh i mean i don't think so but you know i don't want to create a lot of additional work although this does not seem like it would take committee of 50 the way the first one did to do to add this particular standard to it or for us to vote to eliminate it you know with regard to where we are i know miss holton has got some

[01:16:12] language suggestions about pulling some things out uh and adding a sentence as you know she mentioned and i think you've got that language written in uh you know i am sorry sorry yeah go ahead now you can finish i i i sent language to emily and you uh that was i think the what i tried to capture in in what i said and so perhaps if we have a motion today we could reference that and and i think that dr wilson has a couple of discrete language changes that she's proposed

[01:16:47] that i would support yeah you know i certainly am in favor of the addition of the cultural competency standard to where we are um and i'm actually in favor of moving this through in some fashion but you know it is clear that i have reservations about you know you know i guess again making sure that we are clearly communicating where we're going this was not meant to be a major rewrite in my mind of where we were it was specifically to add cultural competency as a

[01:17:27] standard and the uh you know the things that are needed to accomplish that uh you know i raised last time the concern about how do we implement standards before we have professional development and i guess the response actually made some sense to me was if we don't implement the standard we'll never have the professional development i can appreciate that and accept that as you know a decent and you know and fair response uh and it will take some time for that development i will say for the board as a whole you know it is one of my goals at the retreat to begin a review of sort

[01:18:02] of professional development and how it occurs in the commonwealth uh with the idea again of integrating the next evaluation uh guidelines with professional development you know we did make some changes to the hours for farming uh but we have not really addressed how it has to happen and what has to happen and you know are we going to mandate that certain people take certain uh pd based upon

results of evaluations again that will be hopefully april's discussion but ann do you want to you know is there going to be a motion to move this today or is the board i'll get to you

[01:18:38] in a second stuart uh is the board going to you know want to see the final final language before we actually vote on it? Well, I would be prepared to move it forward today. I think the best thing we can do is to get this done so that we can then begin the phase three discussion, which will include what will hopefully be in tandem with professional development topics. But I'm not, I don't have a strong feeling about it, but I'm prepared to offer a motion if you like. Okay,

[01:19:13] let's have dr robertson first and then we'll see if we're at motion phase or if we get further complicated i i believe thank you mr president i believe that ann and i were on the same page there it was it was clear to me that um while there there may be a desire for all of the interlocking pieces to be illustrated as well as they possibly can with this particular assignment it feels like the way to get off center is to entertain a motion and um if if ann wants to make a motion

[01:19:48] i'm glad to second i like that even before you hear what it is right all right miss holton do you have a motion you'd like to make and actually dr wilson before we get to you and just because you mentioned that you had uh technical changes you know can you just sort of briefly run through them so that we are confident that they are in fact you know what everybody considers technical not that i disbelieve you but it's you know important to me that we understand what we're voting on um yeah so mine are along the same lines where places where we are suggesting that there may

[01:20:27] be movement or not so the shoulds versus mays so i've pointed out page eight um there are a couple of places in uh i'm sorry let me go through the pages um synchronous asynchronous i mentioned that. That's in standard two, indicator 2.8. I mentioned that one. Sorry, I've got them dog-eared.

[01:20:57] It's going to take me a minute. That's again the same one. I have a question on professional knowledge, page 24, formal classroom observation form or a feedback form, formative feedback form, it's now called yeah and what is the question page 24 uh under the bullet third bullet on the right column demonstrates an understanding of appropriate accommodations for diverse learners or student

[01:21:32] learn students learning and you should that or be an and students in diverse learning uh students learning in unique context should that or be an and is the question okay and is there a response Dr. Strong, Ms. Pitts? I'm just looking at page 24. Which bullet is it on the right?

[01:21:59] Third one down. The strike through is communicates clearly and checks for understanding. And then you see where it starts there, Dr. Strong? Yes, ma'am. Just demonstrates an understanding of appropriate accommodations for diverse learners or students learning in unique content so my question is should that or be an and i think and would be more apropos

[01:22:36] sorry okay give me a second i think i had just one more that i can find it sorry for the tedium this is hard to do though uh in this format um it that it goes to the other one was the just a repeat of that same one so you know further into the document where we repeat those indicators just the consistency across so we'll go through and sanitize all of those once we make a change thank you that was the that's all i had mr gecker thank you dr wilson miss holton i think

[01:23:12] i can incorporate ms wilson's uh into my motion but my motion would be that we approve item h uh with the following uh amendments that in the forward we delete the section that says multiple data sources and the section that says professional development through feedback and coaching.

[01:23:38] And in lieu thereof, that we add language at the end of the prior bullet describing phase three as follows.

[01:24:01] Phase three is expected to build on the importance of using multiple data sources and of integrating professional development through feedback and coaching into the teacher evaluation system.

[01:24:22] And then I would also amend on page eight, the performance standards, the word should become may in standard 2.8, the and in the phrase about synchronous and asynchronous learning should become and/or.

[01:24:45] and on page 24 in the matter just discussed by Ms. Wilson, or should become and, and other technical adjustments consistent therewith. How did I do? - That was great.

[01:25:02] - I think you did great. And Dr. Robertson apparently seconded it in advance. No, only kidding there. We have a second, so thank you for that. We will do, is there any other discussion? So we will do this by roll call.

[01:25:18] Ms. Davis Vaught, we'll move on. Dr. Garan? - Aye. - Ms. Holton? - Aye. - Dr. Mann? - Aye. - Dr. Pexton? - Aye.

[01:25:34] - Dr. Robertson? - Aye. - Mr. Swan? - Aye. - Dr. Wilson? - Aye. - Ms. Davis Vaught? - Aye. - Okay, Chair votes aye. I would like to say to both Ms. Pitts and to Dr. Strong and frankly, the rest of the staff that worked on this, nobody should take from the sort of discussion we had anything other than appreciation for the work product. This is a complicated area. It is one that, you know, clearly is in significant focus of this board. When you think about the

[01:26:10] changes we wanted here, they're actually fairly minor in the context of the overall work that was done here. And so I'll tell you that for myself, I am very appreciative of what you all have done. You know, we do have strong opinions and sometimes they come out perhaps in not the best way in these meetings but uh you know thank you very much to both and again to all the staff who worked on this this is a complicated and important topic mr geckert do you mind if i just make a quick thank you note as well i i know dr wilson did this but i just wanted to thank leah

[01:26:46] most of the revisions that were done over the last month were were done in leah walker's shop by probably by leah specifically and we had a lot of uh intense conversation i just really appreciate your efforts, Leah, and I just wanted to say that. And Mr. Director, I will promise by next month, we'll think through with you how to rectify that standards document and/or eliminate it, whichever is -- I appreciate that. Okay. Item I was deferred. Item J, final review of proposed temporary flexibility for meeting the sequential elective requirement for Virginia graduates.

[01:27:23] Dr. Sale, good morning. Yes, good morning, everyone. And let me get my screen pulled up for us. this as you know is also a topic of great interest for the board and therefore one that will generate a lot of debate oh boy i well i i can't say i wasn't warned then so uh good morning to everyone to president gecker vice president wilson members of the board and dr lane um thank you for allowing me a few minutes of your time today to present the proposed amendments to guidance regarding

[01:27:58] the sequential elective requirement for virginia graduates so i will start very quickly by sharing a little bit more about the guidance document that's under review here this morning and the board's guidance that pertains to the sequential elective requirement is actually part of a larger resource

document titled the guidance document governing certain provisions of the regulations establishing standards for accrediting public schools in virginia so it's a very descriptive title but we also and most commonly refer to that as the soa guidance document so if you hear that

[01:28:33] reference um that is what we were we are referring to here the soa guidance document is actually a compilation of both board and department guidance that expounds on a number of provisions and the board's regulations establishing the standards of accreditation among the specific provisions addressed in the guidance document are clarifications for how students may fulfill graduation requirements and of relevance for us here today is that sequential elective for a little bit of an

[01:29:09] additional context around what exactly the sequential elective requirement is i just wanted to provide a short overview of that particular requirement and what that entails as you can see from the language excerpt in the middle of the slide the sequential elective is actually a statutory requirement the purpose of which is to ensure that students are taking a series of two courses that give them a foundation and then deeper understanding of a chosen subject matter that will serve them in post secondary endeavors formerly the two sequential electives

[01:29:44] were a requirement for only the standard diploma but with legislation that came from the 2016 general assembly this requirement was actually extended to all students regardless of diploma type and then we incorporated that change from the 200 2016 legislative session into our so Waiver visions that were finalized in 2017. So because of this change to the sequential elective requirement came alongside a number of other changes and things happening in the standards of accreditation, staff has learned that there have been some inconsistencies in how our sequential

[01:30:21] elective requirement is understood and therefore being applied at the local level. So and further we've learned that some of the divisions were unaware that we had additional clarifying guidance around the sequential elective which may have contributed to our misunderstanding but as we think about how we work to address this issue we wanted to seek a solution that would would not create a barrier to graduation for potentially impacted students here so that's the reason for our approach in rethinking the the guidance document and providing this temporary flexibility

[01:30:52] currently the guidance document does already allow or provide some clarity in how the sequential elective requirement can be met as well as some flexibility for the types of coursework that apply so your two sequential electives for a graduating student may be in any discipline as long as those courses are not already specifically required for graduation in the standards of accreditation the guidance document does provide some clarity around what courses can be used or flexibility rather one of them being that a fine arts course can be used to partially satisfy the sequential

[01:31:32] elective requirement and i will explain in more detail what that personal satisfaction means through an example which i think is the the easiest way to kind of digest um that that particular provision and i will note that in addition to this standing guidance the superintendent of public instruction has issued a waiver of the sequential elective requirement for certain students graduating this school year per his authority in the appropriation act and the reason for this particular waiver is we recognize that COVID-19 has had a significant impact on course availability as well as how some students have been able to kind of pursue their course trajectory

[01:32:09] and coursework as planned which may have limited some students access to the courses they had intended to use for the sequential elective requirement. So there is some space and existing flexibility

but we know that that might not kind of correct for all of the outstanding concerns here so with that in mind and in addition to the waiver which does provide some immediate relief for our students graduating this year the issue of the fulfillment of sequential electives may continue to impact students particularly in upcoming cohorts and particularly for those

[01:32:45] advanced studies diploma students and these students who are those that have charted their coursework and schedules based on an unclear understanding of what sequential electives are and which courses could be used. So in response to that, one of the most substantive changes that we're bringing to you today in the guidance document is the addition of a temporary flexibility for students graduating in the 2021-2022 or 2022-2023 school years to use a world language course to partially satisfy the sequential elective requirement, so long as the total number of

[01:33:19] required credits for the diploma are still achieved. There are a few other changes to the document that we have here before you today um the big item again being that temporary flexibility piece but there are proposed amendments to include the addition of language regarding career and technical education courses also being used to partially satisfy this requirement this was actually inadvertently not carried over from class past iterations of the sequential elective section of the soa guidance document and the reason for that was just a result of of the disconnect between changes in terminology

[01:33:59] from practical arts to CTE and changes in graduation requirements. So when we did make that shift in language, the practical arts language appeared to be obsolete when we thought about what we needed to include in the SOA guidance document. So that particular flexibility was deleted rather than replaced with career and technical education.

[01:34:20] And because of that historical context and kind of understanding how that came together why the practical arts and now cte language was not incorporated staff felt it was appropriate to reincorporate this language as a permanent fixture of the soa guidance document but of course will be a complement to the temporary flexibility and further expand pathways to meeting the sequential elective requirement and lastly just as a quick note for the proposed revisions we did make a technical and clarifying edit to address a frequently asked question on the sequential elective requirement which states that a two credit course may be may also be used to fulfill

[01:34:57] the requirement assuming that it meets the other conditions for the sequential elective requirement so as i noted i think maybe the easiest way to understand how these changes are going to come together in practice is through a more concrete example so on your screen here is a visual of the relevant graduation requirements for both types of diplomas under the new graduation requirements and subsection 51 of the standards of accreditation so a student seeking a standard diploma may take an arts one course or and a spanish one course to meet their fine arts cte and world language disciplinary requirement so you see they're meeting their two standard units of credit in

[01:35:37] that discipline area whereas the language now would only allow the students to take an arts two course as a fine arts to meet the sequential elective requirements the new flexibility will give this student another pathway so the student may now elect to take arts 2 or spanish 2 to complete their sequential elective requirements for our advanced studies diploma student we can see how this additional flexibility may be particularly helpful as they are already required to take a world language as part of their diploma studies so they can build on the coursework for this discipline area to meet the sequential elective requirement but of course for these

[01:36:16] students the option remains for them to take an additional fine arts and assuming approval a cte course using that sequence of credits to complete the fine arts cte discipline area as well as their sequential elective requirement so the solution that we came up with we felt ensure that students are meeting both the sequential and elective components of that requirement so it's coursework that builds on itself and again provides that foundation and deeper understanding but one of those courses is outside of the requirement required discipline areas so it is an elective

[01:36:50] course and something that a student must have chosen beyond the graduation requirements so i will say that this is um recommended by the superintendent uh for to have the board wave final review or first review and receive for final review this particular update to the guidance document keeping in mind that some of our students graduating this year may also benefit from the additional flexibility and as students think about their coursework in years to come they can plan using this additional flexibility but i will actually leave this screen up for us um so if there are any questions about how this might work in practice or any additional information i can

[01:37:29] provide um we have this as a reference here for us to to use as discussion and i will hand it back to to mr gecker here um to facilitate any additional discussion or other board members have questions for me i'm happy to answer thank you dr stella i would ask if you don't mind actually you can take it down because i can't see oh sure the body when the screen is shared in that way i'm sorry about that oh no absolutely well we can pull it back up if we need it yeah

[01:37:57] one of the limitations of the meeting we're using okay are there any questions i don't see anybody okay uh then is there a motion to wave first review and adopt this as proposed or another motion of some sort i'll move to leave first review and thank you dr duran is there a second to that thank you dr robertson uh again by uh roll call uh miss davis vaught hi dr duran

[01:38:37] hi uh miss holton hi dr mann hi dr pexton hi uh mr roberts uh dr robertson hi mr swan uh dr wilson aye and chair votes aye uh it has been suggested and i agree with the suggestion we take a quick 10-minute break uh thank you dr sale for the great presentation it was so clear we didn't need to leave that one up there so we will be back at uh you know 11 42 if that's okay

[01:39:14] looks like we're still waiting on oh dr man i think it's just getting ready to pop in we're

[01:49:12] still waiting on dr duran and dr wilson dr wilson's there too all right so we're ready we are ready thanks everybody for being so prompt uh we will move on to item k first review of child care regulations transferring from the board of social services to the board of education uh ms conway welcome back thank you good morning again uh i'll ask at least emily we pull up the slides perfect uh good morning again um i am very pleased to present this morning on behalf of our

[01:49:51] team some information about the need to transition the child care regulations from the board of social services to the board of education so this as most of you know and this is maybe new for our two new board members but this is work that has been underway for the greater part of of two years a year ago the state passed legislation that set you all in charge the board of education with us to support the implementation of it of oversight for all out of the home early childhood

[01:50:26] care and education programs this is set to go into effect on july 1st of this year as i have brief you periodically over the course of the last year even with the pandemic we are still on track to do this we've moved over some staff over the course of the last year we moved over last summer and we have been

working very closely with all of the different aspects of government all the letters from the attorney general's office to the department of social services department of planning and budget and our all different aspects of the department of education have been working on this

[01:51:04] one step important step in this process is just the formal move of the regulations and so we've got to move those over from the department of social services to the department of education there are three general areas of regulation that we need to move over i know there were lots of pages but let me just summarize the three areas so the first are the regulations that pertain to child care licensing and monitoring this is different from what uh miss pitts does in terms of licensing of teachers this is the licensing or the health and safety expectations for child care

[01:51:41] sites which range from faith-based programs more traditional child care centers family day homes it's the licensing of health and safety it's not related at all to the educators that's number one number two is the child care subsidy program this is a scholarship or voucher program that provides low-income families that are working in our school with financial assistance to go to child care and then lastly there's a small child care scholarship program which again provides eligible early childhood educators with financial assistance for child development coursework

[01:52:17] as we help to further elevate the profession so those are the three areas i know there were multiple documents but those are generally speaking the three areas that are moving from the board of social services to the board of education emily next slide so let me talk a little bit about the process because this is is is unique in that we are this is this is entirely uh technical changes and let me explain what that means is that when we worked very closely with the governor's office with the general assembly with stakeholders across the state the general consensus was that it would

[01:52:55] be too complicated to change all the regulations and move everything at the same time and so we decided we would take a phased in approach which was we would move everything as is and then work really closely with the new advisory committee that was set up in that very same wall that moved everything to review align and streamline regulations so the changes in front of you really are entirely technical in nature so for example changing it from social services to education commissioner to superintendent we had to refer to the new law their new code references

[01:53:32] statutory authority that we struck some text that was related to adult care and child welfare programs that were under the purview of the board of social services that wouldn't be appropriate here and there was the law called on the change for related to regulations for child support enforcement so again these are all in direct response to the law none of these are substantive and that's important because as you might imagine we need to do this in fairly short order for these to go into effect on july 1st so you might as you read through as you review them there might be things where you're like oh i think we should change this this feels out of date and there

[01:54:09] will be time to do that in the future but our commitment to the general assembly and to the stakeholders is that we would move this over as is in order to minimize disruption to the field so again in summary these are technical changes only um we as we've talked about with you we'll come back we'll come back to the health and safety licensing we'll come back to how we set eligible eligibility who which families are eligible for the child care subsidy program how we set rates right to make sure that we are helping more and more vulnerable families get access to child care that helps prepare their children for kindergarten and

[01:54:46] how we think about elevating the profession you know the potential expansion of scholarships but we need to do that after July 1st and we would do that in partnership with the new early childhood advisory committee that you all approved at the last meeting and that met for the first time in February and then lastly just to kind of give you a sense of what this means for the future just wanted to help you kind of lay the timeline so as i noted we have in response to the law kicked off the ecac or the early childhood advisory committee that you all appointed this was the one member

[01:55:20] that there were 160 applications for about 22 positions today we are asking you to work on the transition of the child care regulations and we'll bring it back for final review next month we will also bring to you the first regulation that we're changing and this is the brand new regulation around the practice years for the measurement and improvement system we continue to work behind the scenes to have a seamless transition as is of licensing subsidy oversight and any remaining aspects related to the child care block grant on july 1st and then summer into

[01:55:56] fall then we will come back and bring these same regulations but with some of the changes that we've talked about we've talked about working about on before so unifying the system i'm really thinking through what changes are needed in order to ensure that more children more vulnerable children in Virginia have access to programs that help prepare them for kindergarten so you see that over the fall and winter so again technical changes today you'll need your thumbs up today we'll need your approval in April to sort of get those in place for July 1st with the expectation that we will come back within the next 12 to 18 months to to sort of add some more substantive

[01:56:33] changes based on this being at the board of education and wanting to unify the system with that um let me see if there's any questions about these uh technical changes yeah are there any questions by board members uh i guess mr swan and dr arbertson the licensed staff would they be required to renew just like a regular teacher would be um based off of videoe so that's a great question this licensing and it's confusing because it uses the same term is entirely differently so

[01:57:12] So this is actually, if you own a childcare center, this is the checklist of things that you have to do to keep kids healthy and safe, right? So it's sort of things like, you know, is the medication up on a shelf? Is there enough sort of enough inches of mulch out on the playground?

[01:57:30] It's completely related to the health and safety of the site rather than the educator. So it's different from the typical VDOE licensing. So it really doesn't pertain at all to educators. There is not a requirement right now.

[01:57:47] Childcare educators don't have to be licensed in the same way that pre-K-12 educators have to be licensed. And this would not affect that at this point in time. We might come back to that in the future, but it would not affect it at this point in time. Great question, Mr. Swan. - Thank you.

[01:58:05] Stuart. - Yes, thank you, Jenna. I'll just make a quick comment and then a really low impact question. My quick comment is that I guess 30 to 35 years ago, I had a partial business interest in childcare business offered in our hometown at the time.

[01:58:29] It was a family-run business and certainly got a clear indication of the immense number of regulations associated with the operation of childcare center a good reason. I just make the observation that all of these responsibilities moving over to DOE is not insignificant. I can only imagine what this is

going to mean and will entail in terms of oversight and staffing and resources. It's not insignificant. My question is, and again I'm

[01:59:09] hearkening back to past i at one point was a member of the child care advisory board for the state i don't know if such an entity still exists or if doe will have the benefit of such a citizen advisory board i'm just questioning i tried googling it here i don't see anything popping up but um maybe you know off the top of your head sure so i know that there have been several groups and there's several sort of associations as well what we did is add into

[01:59:46] the legislation last year this new early childhood advisory committee which includes all types of child care centers so it includes a entirely private center it includes a center that takes public funding it includes a faith-based center it includes a family day home program care program so it has a variety it includes a head start program that is run in a licensed center not at a school so it does include kind of all of the different types of programs and so that's our new formal body and any policy we bring to you going forward we'll go to them first so for

[02:00:23] instance we're bringing policies to you all in april and we're taking it to that group next week and so that is our way largely because i think what you've just expressed is something i know I've heard from other members of the board this is we're taking on a significant amount of work and it's a different space and how can we be sure that these things have been thoroughly vetted and so creating that advisory committee was one way to do that I think separately we work very closely with all of the various associations the head start association the child care association the family day home association to make sure that a variety of child care providers

[02:01:03] are represented and we can hear their perspective so it's a very important point licensing is a big deal as the parent of young children who has put as young as a three-month-old in licensed care there is nothing more important right than keeping uh particularly our infants and our toddlers safe and so you know we really want to make sure that we work very closely with our providers to do that the advisory committee also includes folks like child care where the virginia representative of the american association of pediatrics right other folks who are thinking about the well-being

[02:01:42] of infants toddlers and preschoolers so that again as we review those licensing regulations we're thinking both from the practitioner perspective how do we put these things in place partner with educators to keep young children particularly infants and toddlers safe but also we're hearing from child advocates and medical professionals who often see the flip side of that, right, when kids are involved in accidents, when things go badly, and so really making sure that we have that group. So that group is in action, and we are certainly -- I'll work with Emily to make sure that everybody, if you ever want to listen in to the advisory committee,

[02:02:20] more than make sure that you all get the invites. Thank you. Okay, thank you. Anybody else? I don't see anybody so what dr wilson no okay all right then uh miss conway thank you so much the board will receive this for first review and we look forward to seeing you next month okay we will move on then to item l uh first review of proposed curriculum guidelines for instruction on the safe

[02:02:55] use of and risks of abuse of prescription drugs uh miss wigand yes good morning president members of the Board, Dr. Lane. I am delighted to present for first review the proposed curriculum guidelines for instruction on the safe use and risk of abuse of prescription drugs. The 2018 General

Assembly amended the code to require the Board to develop these guidelines. The proposed guidelines were developed in collaboration with health educators, substance use specialists, the U.S.

[02:03:29] Attorney's Office, CASEL, Drug Enforcement Special Agents, and other passionate stakeholders. The Standards of Learning for Health Education serve as a framework for the proposed curriculum guidelines and empower students to acquire health knowledge, effective refusal skills, social awareness, and informed responsible decision-making skills when it comes to prescription drugs. The proposed guidelines also emphasize actionable recommendations for strategic planning that optimizes health literacy empowers teachers encourages collaborative family and

[02:04:08] community supports and culturally responsive curriculum that reinforces positive norms that most students do not engage in risky drug use and do not think risky drug use is acceptable students learn about the science of addiction how to properly use and dispose of prescription drugs how to intervene when faced with situations involving drug misuse, and skills to make healthy decisions that enhance protective factors and reverse or reduce risky factors.

[02:04:44] The proposed guidelines also encourage prevention curriculum tailored to address the type of drug abuse problem in the local community that targets modifiable risk factors and strengthens protective factors by increasing academic and social competence through peer relationships, self-efficacy, communication skills, assertiveness, and healthy coping skills. Research shows that each dollar invested in prevention education yields significant savings in the treatment of substance abuse. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends the Board of Education

[02:05:22] received for first review the proposed curriculum guidelines for instruction on the safe use and risk of abuse of prescription drugs thank you very much are there any questions or comments about board members dr wilson thank you ms wigan i have one quick question in the document under section 5 item 1 it says here that guidelines developed by the board and approved by the state board of health can you explain just a little bit about the process and how those two pieces fit

[02:05:57] together so after first review um the proposed guidelines will go to the state board of health for their approval and then come back to you for final approval and adoption so any suggestions or changes that they would have we would see in the second read yes great thank you that helps anybody else i don't see anybody uh and so thank you very much the board will take this on first review and

[02:06:34] we'll see you soon thank you okay we move on to uh the written reports and item m i understood that there might be a request for some discussion on this is that right uh yes all right mr gecker i had just said that i suggested that if time permitted perhaps staff could give us some highlights from verbally of the legislative report, but if time does not permit, we can all

[02:07:10] just study the written report. No, I think time permits if that's okay. You know, we are moving right along schedule and we dropped an item, so we're in good shape here. So is that Ms. Coy or?

[02:07:26] I think it is. Good afternoon now, President Gecker and members of the board. Holly Coy, assistant superintendent for policy equity and communications and dr sale is here too uh to tag team with me on this particular matter but um just uh in addition to the written report that you have as part of your materials uh i thought we'd give you just a kind of quick overview and summary and then happy to answer questions on any particular bills that caught your interest so overall this session was a bit of a strange one given the virtual environment that we found

[02:08:03] ourselves in. A bit unique, but that had some benefits. There were bill limits, so the volume overall was generally down compared to what we see in a regular session. We were also in the midst of a biennial budget cycle, and so the budget conversations were significant in part due to COVID, but we were in the midst of that cycle and so amending the existing budget, which has seen many revisions over the last year. Generally in the K-12 arena there was a lot of discussion around

[02:08:40] reopening schools as you might imagine as well as growth assessments and I can speak specifically to the actions taken there. There was also a lot of discussion about the JLARC reports that were issued last fall on special education, CSA, and a few pieces as it related to the agency's JLARC report. In addition to that, there were SOQ bills put forward reflecting this board's recommendations and there was one that was successful this year in part on one piece of that. Additionally,

[02:09:19] the work around culturally responsive teachers and educators was advanced via a governor's bill and that was successful this year and so there were some conversations as it relates to equipping educators in our buildings uh to provide you know culturally responsive classrooms and environments for our students um i think there was a little bit of interest in hearing about the growth assessment bill so i'm happy to speak to those i see some heads nodding so there were two bills

[02:09:50] house bill 2027 and senate bill 1357 addressing gross assessments and these bills in their final formed phase in some changes to how we assess students in grades three through eight just in math and reading so those are the only kind of subjects and grades that were touched by this bill and the idea is that the state would use some of the federal covered relief dollars to assess students in those grades and subjects a little bit differently again phasing in overtime so that

[02:10:28] ultimately the end goal of this bill is that those students would be assessed at the beginning, the middle, and the end of the school year and that they would be assessed off of grade level. And so using essentially our SOL system, our computer adaptive testing, thinking about the SOL assessments that we have now as Legos and kind of taking them apart and rebuilding them in some different ways um so we have the infrastructure to do this it will take us like i said some time to turn all the elements turn on all the elements that the legislation requires

[02:11:05] uh and to phase that in but that is the end goal of those bills that were successful this session i'll pause there uh are there questions on the growth assessment bills in particular Ms. Halton and then Mr. Swan.

[02:11:23] Yes, thank you, Holly. That's very helpful. On the growth assessment, Bill, as I understand it, requiring that we use growth measures or that we administer tests to show growth third through eighth grade, does it either require us to change anything about how we accredit schools based on growth versus proficiency, or would it facilitate potential changes to that that we might want to consider even if not mandate so that's a wonderful question uh the bill itself

[02:12:02] does not speak specifically to that um but the the implication is that it would affect how we um i said you know how we use growth within our accreditation model so using that growth within the school year instead of just spring of one year to spring of the next year we'll have a more nuanced picture of that so um and i see julia's on here too as well as shelly so they can can hop in and complement anything that i've said here but we do understand that it would have implications for accreditation and the ways in which we um kind of have the inputs for that growth measure i'll add

[02:12:41] one thing to that miss holton and that it does allow us to measure growth in third grade which we've never been able to do which was a request that you had asked for in the past and so that's one nice feature of this new bill. That's great and and so I hear you it will help us rejigger how we do the growth part of our SOA assessments but I guess sort of looking at the language of the bill and I didn't analyze it that closely does it mean to have the growth assessments replace the

[02:13:13] proficiency assessments or is the contemplation that this will just improve upon our growth assessments um and that we will continue to have use administer and use proficiency measures alongside growth measures for those grades and subjects yes so the the understanding is that it would provide those more nuanced growth measures that would supplement uh the proficiency you know

[02:13:47] required proficiency scores at the end of the year for every student supplement but not replace right so essentially uh you need a pre and a post assessment to measure growth right that those are two requirements the the summative assessment at the end of the year will still exist you'll just measure growth to that from the pre-assessment which will now be in the fall and eventually fall and winter i'm just looking at the summary of the bill language that says in lieu of a one-time end of your assessment so i wonder if there's more ambiguity on that and if we know you know hopefully

[02:14:26] clarify you all know what the um uh patron's intent is but i i had some communication with the patron early on and i had thought the intent i i don't i didn't understand the nuance of it so i don't know but i just wonder about the patron's intent and recognizing i don't know that this has been signed yet so if there is a need for clarification i don't know if there is having worked with the patrons really both of them um you know they're intending for this to be three computer adaptive assessments a year and they recognize that under federal law we're required

[02:15:05] to create a summative response with the one at the end of the year okay so so we don't have the flexibility even if we wanted to to go all growth we have to still have proficiency a summative measure because of the federal requirements okay thank you for that clarification okay mr swan um thank you uh and that actually answered some of my questions um my my follow-up question will be

[02:15:38] excuse me will us as teachers have the ability to use these assessments to help drive our instructions and if so what is the turnaround uh to get the results to help drive our instruction mr kwan i think that was absolutely part of the intent of the patrons was to provide better more nuanced data throughout the year uh to to you and your colleagues i can't speak to the turnaround time but perhaps shelly and julie might be able to yes mr swan um we will use the the

[02:16:14] current system of reporting we have so you will have almost immediate results so it will be available to your school division within 24 hours this is probably also a good time for me to make the board aware that we're also designing a data warehousing system and data analytics tool that we're referencing as laser. And once these reports are available through the Pearson-based system, we can also upload them to the laser system so that they can be analyzed at the local

[02:16:52] level simultaneously as well uh that project uh will probably start to be piloted right around the time that these assessments will be piloted and eventually be proliferated in all divisions that want it okay anybody else if not thank you to everybody from the department on this uh i think that move i guess that's it for that on uh we will move on then to uh discussion of current issues

[02:17:27] uh dr pexton thank you good afternoon um i just want to take an opportunity as the uh chair or the um special committee to review the standards of accreditation uh to share uh a little bit of information about one presentation that we received yesterday i received several very good informing presentations but we were really pleased as a committee and as a board who attended the the session to be joined by members of the african-american superintendents advisory council And for those that may not be familiar with the Council, their purpose was to advise, inform,

[02:18:07] and provide professional insight on policy development and accountability for public education in Virginia. And that Council was formed to provide advice and recommendations to Dr. Lane and to the VDOE leadership. And like yesterday at our special committee meeting, they were called upon to inform the board on policy matters.

[02:18:27] So given our special committee's review of SOAs, and the focus on equity and accountability, the work and the recommendations of the AASAC was very complimentary to our work. And so we were pleased to be joined by Mr. Rashard Wright, who's the chief of staff at Newport News Public Schools, and Dr. Tamisha Grimes, who's the superintendent of Nottaway County Public Schools, and Secretary Jim Dyke, the former Virginia Secretary of Education to Governor Wilder.

[02:18:58] But we were really pleased to be joined by their student school board representative from Portsmouth City Public Schools, Mr. Miles Hunt, which I think I can speak for the board, we're all thoroughly impressed with. And so I just wanted to share that we had that opportunity to hear from that council and had some very robust discussions.

[02:19:19] They provided us with a list of recommendations that from their perspective that could help inform our current standards of accreditation. It was very comprehensive in their approach as far as how they are challenging our thinking and making sure that we are really looking at opportunities to insert equity across the board for our students in Virginia.

[02:19:51] So it was really encouraged by the presentation, by the recommendations. The board certainly has some work ahead of us to really evaluate those recommendations and really understand where we see opportunities consider them and apply them but i just wanted to share uh that we you know the opportunity we have with a broader audience and would absolutely welcome any other committee members or board members who would want to add their perspective to the discussion that we had okay thank you uh dr wilson thank you president gecker dr pexton thanks um so uh to echo your comments dr pexton

[02:20:29] really great conversation um and you know the thing that i pointed out yesterday that i'll just reiterate here is that the recommendations which came forward from the asac are certainly reflective of the work that we as a board have been doing over the last several years certainly since i joined the board in 2017 and is consistent with the comprehensive plan that we've laid out with the work that we've been doing in our special committees and so i'm encouraged that there is alignment in what that committee that council has done or has recommended and the work that we

[02:21:06] have been doing are doing now and see ourselves moving into in the future so i just wanted to to draw that line that through line between the work of the committee and the board so thank you dr pexton and staff for ensuring that we have the opportunity to hear from that council anybody else you and then miss halton yep and and if it's on uh dr pexton's topic i can i can wait i just going to make my monthly remarks uh if it's at that moment and miss holton we'll come back okay

[02:21:46] uh well i just wanted to uh two things i wanted to raise one uh just to generally make sure the public knows that we do appreciate the public comment we receive from you and the department works hard to make sure it gets to all of us before the board meeting and i i miss the opportunity to hear from you in person but your comment we are reading it and it is invaluable i particularly recognized this month among other things that we heard from the vea reiterating a point that dovetails with the discussion that mr swan just started us on earlier today about how do we help

[02:22:25] teachers adjust to the new culturally responsive standards and the vea letter in particular it stressed the importance of professional development being working in tandem with the new evaluations so i know we're i know we're hard at work on that but you know we don't want to be holding teachers accountable to something we haven't given them an opportunity to learn and i appreciate that point that the vea raised another matter raised in the public comment that

[02:22:55] i'd like to address is the gifted program our guidelines with respect to gifted programs and particularly governor schools i am remembering now which i had forgotten but that we are in the midst of rewriting the regulations for governor school and there's been talk about whether we should be doing guidelines for governor school but as we all know guidelines carry less weight than regulations and if i'm correct we're in the middle of an apa process revising the regulations for

[02:23:30] gifted programs and i wonder if we should be in response to the issues raised in the comment whether we should be pulling those back in for another look one of the specifics raised in some of the comment for instance suggests that our current regulations require the governor's schools to use a standardized test as part of their admissions criteria. And there are some members of public who are urging us to remove that requirement. I don't know whether we should remove that requirement or not, but since we are in the midst of a revision, is now a good time

[02:24:10] rather than letting the regulatory process get too far along without looking at those issues and whether there are other matters we want to address in the regulations in response to the public comment or otherwise do we want to take another look at the special ed regs and if so what's the best way to do that dr lynn do you want to go do you want me to take this one uh you go first and i'll fill in so uh thank you miss holton um just for the public's awareness um all of the

[02:24:45] public comment that we received um is posted on the website and miss holton is referring to several letters that we received from the public, as well as one from the African-American Superintendent's Advisory Committee. The regulations are in the proposed stage and in executive branch review. My understanding is we could pull them back if we wanted to.

[02:25:07] You will have another crack at them through final stage, but traditionally there aren't major revisions in the final stage because that kind of kicks it back to starting over. um so if it were the the will in the interest of the board we could pull them back i i should have checked exactly where they are i think they may be in the governor's office but they certainly have not been approved and so they are still in that proposed stage and we do have um you know the flexibility to pull them back and bring them back to the board while we're in proposed stage and

[02:25:39] maybe uh before we talk about whether you want to do that emily uh the governor can also suggest amendments in the executive review process. And since this bill that failed was a governor's priority, he very well may consider doing that. So you may want to let the executive review play out

because it may come back to you and you can get through that step with much of what you would want to see and still make amendments and final. I think it might be more difficult for us to make

[02:26:13] amendments and final once it's gone through. You know, it's a good time, I guess, to bring up items that aren't otherwise on the agenda. So I appreciate this one coming up. I mean, the bill did fail, but we have been asked by a number of people, legislators included, to take a more serious look at, you know, some of the aspects of not only the admissions policies, but also the feeder policies. And, you know, I personally believe that it is, you know, something that we ought to do and bring back to us and look at more, when I say more seriously, because I think

[02:26:51] looked at them seriously the first time but look at them with a different light on it than we had the first time we went through this process with an eye you know to me it's a deeper issue and you know we raised this when they came through then you know how do we balance the admissions you know or what we use for the admission standards to me it goes back to how do we provide you know equitable access in the younger years so that you know as people come through the system they have the same shot as anybody else going through the system and it is clear we don't have you know equitable

[02:27:30] opportunities you know i think and i was on you know with uh senator lucas the sort of committee that uh secretary carney asked to review this and you know learned a lot i think that one of the statistics that i heard and i'm not gonna not 100 sure this is the right number but i think there was only one student at tj who was not identified gifted in the third grade i mean the number of kids who get in who are not uh identified early is you know shockingly small and you know to me

[02:28:05] that points out you know disparities in the identification which were again highlighted by the presentation yesterday although you know known to us and you know frankly the resource differentials that you see. You know, again, it's much like, you know, you've heard me talk about before, as long as we can predict outcomes by zip code, we know we haven't achieved equity.

[02:28:26] I mean, frankly, as long as you can predict the admission to TJ by socioeconomic status, we clearly have not achieved equity. And so I personally would like to see us bring this back, you know, not with the idea necessarily of, you know, moving too heavy-handedly into the local jurisdiction's role in determining admissions, but perhaps to be slightly more heavy-handed in what we require in terms of resource allocation and identification processes

[02:29:03] so that we can begin the pipeline much earlier than we're seeing it done now. Yeah, Mr. Gecker, just one one follow up. I just want to clarify my point to the totally fine to bring the regulations back and go about that process.

[02:29:21] I was just thinking about the fastest way to get to it actually being signed. But I would not in the meantime, I would not delay considering guidelines because the regulations can take so long, especially if you pull them back.

[02:29:36] And so I would I would actually just ask you to consider both. The other thing I would say is some of the things in some of the public comments, I just want to make sure we give you a full picture of what the regs actually say and all that because the regs do require an assessment for gifted ID but not for admission and there's some nuances there that I think it'll be important for us to walk the board through, but I do think that we can do guidance while we're awaiting regulations and bring regulations back if that's the will of the board.

[02:30:06] and so one thing to note um i did i did just double check where we are in the executive branch review we are um in the governor's office um but as i mentioned earlier we can pull them back um if this is kind of the consensus of the board we would bring a board item to you in april to officially withdraw this proposed stage um and susan if i'm saying anything wrong please let me know i know that this is the process that we typically take um we will bring a board item if if you all want to to pull them back um from proposed stage but you would still have the nora

[02:30:44] open so you could move you know whenever you get to the next stage of revisions you know we could take a month or two to work on that we could then jump right back into proposed stage um to keep this process moving along which would then kick it back into executive branch review so if i may just respond briefly that what process we use whether we ask that whether we pull the regs back or whether we await the governor's office action my suggestion would be that we ask you president gecker to work with the department and the secretary's office and figure out the best course

[02:31:24] but that substantively we've had enough new issues raised that i'm not advocating for any particular change but i don't think for instance that we looked at the question of the required assessments when we were looking at this before and are we in the right place on it or not and would would absolutely want to get educated by the department and there and it may be things that we're doing that are going to be giving more direction to the divisions and it may be something where we're giving them less because right now there may be some things in the regs that are impediments to

[02:31:58] local actions to promote equity so um i i just think that there are enough new issues that have been raised that we didn't consider before that we'd like another bite at the apple how we best get that in what order without unduly slowing the painfully slow already apa process i'd happily defer to you all to figure out uh then if it meets the oh dr robertson robertson excuse me uh i'll uh just uh affirm what secretary holton just said the um despite the fact that the bill

[02:32:38] failed uh you know i'm going to play the rookie card again today in my first uh public business meeting uh the um you know each of you has greater awareness of the processes that are involved for reconsideration but despite the fact that the bill failed we have we have a constituent group that has come to us and made a specific argument for our consideration and review so it strikes me that whatever mechanism we can employ which is appropriate that this does merit a board review

[02:33:16] or a board discussion or again whatever mechanism is developed it's it appears important for us to send the signal to the community that the board's attention has been drawn to this and what i would propose as much as secretary i guess what secretary polton proposed that i would adopt is that in conversation with the superintendent with the secretary we figure out best mechanism to bring this back before us and uh you know maybe the board could have some trust in me that you know

[02:33:51] we'll find what would be a satisfactory solution to how it comes back whether it be the guidelines pulling them back waiting for the governor etc but we'll uh talk it through and of course dr wilson would be involved in those discussions sort of nodding of heads on that or gee is that terrible okay and uh stewart just so you know i played the rookie card for a full two years and uh i still often talk about my lack of education background and expertise so feel free you don't have you can't pull that one but feel free to be a rookie for a while thank you uh okay i know james you

[02:34:29] had something to say i i did want to just for a second and because i think james will probably wrap this up uh to dr wilson's point you know we've heard over the last geez you know four years uh since

we started working on the comprehensive plan from a lot of groups who have brought brought forward a lot of statistics about what's occurring out in the field in particular with regard to achievement gaps with regard to inequitable resources etc and you know i greatly appreciate yesterday's presentation uh and i would point again to dr bolson's comment that

[02:35:08] you know their direction really is our direction and has been our direction for a while we are very studiedly working through the issues uh if you read the comp plan we're pretty much right on track for where we ought to be in terms of the equity agenda the uh that is not to say by the way that i think we have the exclusive uh you know knowledge on this i don't and every time a group speaks it does inform where we go but i think it actually hurts a little bit when we treat all the new

[02:35:46] statistics as gee just jumping out and brand new uh and now we ought to start a direction when really in my view we have announced the direction and you know we're about midway through the process you know it's a it's a big system and as we talked about before you know there's a lot of documents out there that need to be looked at integrated harmonized etc and you know i'm very happy personally and i hope the rest of the board is somewhat content with the speed at which we've been able to move on things like the SOQs, the SOAs, et cetera, that I, you know, give full credit to Dr. Pexton, you know, that moving through that second piece of it, that is the review.

[02:36:27] And as I said, at the retreat coming up in April, I expect we will lay the groundwork for sort of the next major phase of our agenda, which is, you know, equity for sure. It is, I think, as we described it in the comp plan, as was reiterated yesterday, you know, our goal is to have the appropriate educational opportunity for all the children in the commonwealth regardless of where they're from i mean it's just that simple and uh you know i guess that's all i've got to say on that but it is very important to me to note that uh you know there are times when i would just like

[02:37:05] to do it and be done with it and say this is the end but the process is important you know you don't pull people along you don't change hearts and minds if you just ram things down people's throats the process is important and i am very respectful always of you know the process and i think the process that we've adopted is a good one the extent people want to suggest changes certainly we're open to that we always have been open to that but uh i would like us to continue marching so with that having been said james i know you had some wrap-up comments thank you president

[02:37:44] gecker uh first on behalf of the the department i also want to take a moment and welcome dr robertson and mr swan to the board i've obviously welcomed you individually and personally but i i just um am excited to have both of you here and really appreciate how how both of you jumped in to the meeting and and feel like a part of the team already so uh thank you and welcome to to the to the work that we do together um i also want to thank the board for the work that you did on teacher evaluation I think that the changes that you made from last month to this month made it even stronger and just really appreciate the constant feedback from the board so we have

[02:38:23] the best product when things are done and then I know Holly referenced this briefly but I I also want to congratulate the board I feel like you got the first movement on your SOQs in this general assembly session and there were SOQs adopted last year related to your SOQs and related to previous board SOQs, but this SOQ related to specialized support and three per thousand. I know we wanted four per thousand, but is a huge step in the right direction and bending that arc towards the board's intent. And several tens of millions of dollars

[02:39:02] in a very difficult financial situation came to our schools because of that and because of the board's push there. So I just wanted to say congratulations on that. Last thing I thought as i tend to do every month is just to talk a little bit about school opening uh on monday we uh we had the governor's deadline to uh have have schools begin opening uh i will say by monday we had a plan from every school division uh and uh uh that uh we were able to get the last few over the line with plans and so most of our schools uh are open at this point are well school divisions

[02:39:39] have some schools that are open at this point. I think April 12th, after spring break, you'll see another set of schools begin to open. And the interesting thing that I found is that it's not just been schools opening, we've seen schools that were going two days a week move to four days a week, we've seen school divisions that were elementary only now going elementary and secondary.

[02:40:01] And so I think we're moving in the right direction and certainly vaccination is helping with that. I haven't read today's vaccination report, but I know that the last report I read said that 80% of faculty and staff have been offered at least the first vaccine, which is an incredibly large number.

[02:40:19] I think we're over 40% of staff are fully vaccinated at this point in our public schools. So I think that's going to continue to help. And in a lot of ways, we see March 15th as a starting point, not an end point. to continue to work with our schools to ramp up from two to four days or four to five days, certainly in alignment with safe guidance and the way that the way that the Virginia Department of Health and CDC would like us to do that. But I think as of today, remote only school divisions is, you know, certainly under 12. I think it might even be under 10 because a couple opened as the

[02:40:57] week has gone on and you may remember we were as high as 67-70 school divisions at one point and so I think the guidance that we put out on January 14th and subsequently readopted essentially last week was helpful but certainly the governor's push in February really gave a strong marker to a lot of school divisions and we've been proud to see that because of that celebration of March 15th i've been out in person touring many many school divisions and have had some incredible experiences one of my favorites when there's more time i'd love to tell you about visiting tangier island

[02:41:33] our last k-12 combined school and going on a boat in 30 mile per hour wind and 10 out 10 foot seas is something i will never forget but but i i will just say that i've been out i'm seeing our schools they are doing mitigation safely the students are extremely excited that are getting to come back and hopefully we'll continue to see more of that so just a thank you to our teachers our staff and all of our leaders for the constant flexibility uh and i i i said in a press release yesterday i think we'll be back to in person being the norm in the fall but we're certainly uh working hard

[02:42:11] to get our school divisions transitioning back to that now and into the the the spring uh and summer so that we can also do the work we need to do to catch our students up uh and so thank you all for your support and and taking on these items related to the pandemic i know they help our school divisions and that is all i have this month mr gecker okay and i think that pretty much is going to conclude us uh to anthony and stewart thank you for being you know new members of the hardest working board in the commonwealth uh this is not an easy gig this is a serious thing and you know

[02:42:47] i certainly we all certainly appreciate you know the clear uh time you spent getting prepared for this meeting you know it's a really very helpful and wonderful thing uh it is actually easier to do these meetings in person uh than it is on the zoom you get much better interaction much better feel for where things are it is our goal thanks to emily's hard work to be back in person for the June meeting. We will be

back next month for the retreat. And as I said, we've got a number of topics that we'll lay out where we're going, you know, for the next couple of years. Stay safe,

[02:43:24] you know, get vaccinated when you can, and see y'all soon. Thank you very much. We are adjourned. Thank you. Bye, everybody. Bye. Thank you all.

